



Examination Report

Geography

6890

EGCSE

2025

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Paper 6890/01

General comments

The number of candidates who registered for the paper increased from 9010 in 2024 to 10100 in 2025 which is a remarkable increase.

Popular question was Question 3 and it was the most accessible as most candidates got relatively high marks, while Question 4 was the least popular. However, those candidates who attempted it managed to score high marks. The most challenging was Question 6

Rubric cases increased this year especially the choice of questions. Candidates did not follow the instructions on the cover page. Common rubrics were; answering two questions in the same theme, answering all questions, or answering two questions only. Candidates are encouraged to read the instructions carefully before answering the questions.

The following part questions proved to be a challenge:

Q1(b)(i), Candidates had a challenge with describing the process of plate collision shown in the figure, they mixed up the steps involved.

Q4(a)(iv) Candidates had a challenge with the features and somehow indicated a challenge with the concept of eco-tourism.

Key points to note

- This paper requires candidates to use the provided resources in each question to assist them in answering the question. They were expected to apply various geographical skills when utilising the resource. Candidates seemed to have a challenge with the application of these skills. These included the analysis of Photographs, application of map reading skills such as direction to describe distribution, and relative location (interpretation of symbols) and distance, interpretation of relief, extracting points from an extract and the reading and analysis of line, bar and multiple bar graphs. Teachers should, therefore, equip candidates with the various geographical skills.
- Definition of terms; Candidates could not define most of the terms asked in the question paper. Major challenges with the following definitions: tectonic plate, climatic region and settlement site were noted. Failure to understand the meanings of key terms or concepts compromised the candidates' responses to some questions. These include the following; features, distribution, trend, ecotourism, satellite towns and sphere of influence.

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- Candidates must read and understand questions carefully to avoid misinterpreting the questions. Misinterpretation was mainly noted in Question 3(b) whereby candidates would refer to the effects of drought in the areas shown instead of describing the distribution of the areas affected. In Question 4(c) they would refer to negative impacts of tourism instead of ways to reduce the impacts, in Question 6 (c) they would also give economic and social factors which affect population distribution.
- Candidates had a challenge with the skill of describing distribution using a map, such that there was poor use of correct terminology such as upper part, middle or lower part of the world map instead of using direction. Candidates also seemed not to be familiar with the world's continents.
- There was evidence that candidates still have a challenge with describing a process in chronological order.
- There was a lack of comparison skill amongst candidates as in most cases when two different features were compared or only one side was described.
- Some candidates still referred to the country as Swaziland instead of Eswatini., this has to be corrected.
- Candidates have to be familiar with the meanings of the following terms or concepts which are commonly used in the subject but not limited to: physical, economic, and social, environmental, characteristics, features, effects, impacts, strategies, measures, positive, negative, process(es), distribution, problems, solutions etc.

Comments on specific questions

Question 1

(a) Study Fig. 1, which shows the world tectonic plates and their direction of movement.

(i) Define a *tectonic plate*.

A majority of candidates failed to correctly define a tectonic plate confusing it with plate tectonics.

Expected response

Slab of solid rock floating on the mantle/ a section of the Earth's crust floating on the mantle

(ii) Name the two tectonic plates labelled **X** and **Y**.

Most candidates were able to correctly identify the plates **X** and **Y**. But those who failed were identifying the types of plates as oceanic or continental. Some even wrote continents instead of the names of the plates. Candidates also lost marks by referring to America instead of North America.

The correct responses were:

X – North American

Y – Eurasian

(iii) Identify the types of plate boundaries at **A, B** and **C**.

This question was challenging for candidates. Instead of identifying plate boundaries, they wrote processes e.g. diverging instead of divergent plate boundary, transformation instead of transformed boundary.

The expected responses were:

A – Destructive/convergent

B – Constructive/divergent

C – Conservative/transform/passive

(iv) Describe **four** differences between a continental and an oceanic plate.

This question was poorly performed. Candidates lacked the comparison skill required by the question, instead they were describing the characteristics of each individual plate without mentioning the characteristic of the other plate. Some candidates could not state the correct opposite terms in their comparison e.g. Oceanic plate lighter and continental plate younger, Continental thick and oceanic heavy which was incorrect.

The correct responses were:

- **Oceanic plate is thin/ 5 km while a continental plate is thick/ 20 – 70km**
- **Oceanic plate is denser while a continental plate is lighter**
- **Oceanic plate sinks while a continental plate is uplifted**
- **Oceanic plate is constantly destroyed while a continental plate is permanent/maintained/rarely damaged**
- **Oceanic plate is mainly covered by oceans while continental is mainly covered by land**
- **Oceanic plate is young while a continental plate is old**
- **Oceanic plates have mafic rocks while continental have felsic rocks**
- **Oceanic plates are made up of SIMA while continental is made up of SIAL**
- **Oceanic have basalt while continental have granite**

(b) Study Fig. 2, which shows a plate boundary.

(i) Describe the processes taking place in this plate boundary.

This question was challenging to candidates. They were unable to describe the process in chronological order. They scored low marks by describing what they saw in Fig. 2. Some candidates even failed to use the resource provided, and wrote unrelated responses. In some cases, candidates referred to either the continental or oceanic plate moving towards the oceanic plate yet both plates are moving towards each other hence the term converge.

Expected responses:

- **continental and oceanic plates converge/collide**
- **denser oceanic plates sinks/subsides under continental plate**
- **continental plate uplifted /folded**
- **edge of oceanic plate melts into the mantle**
- **pressure build up**
- **faulting**
- **a trench is formed**
- **(faulting) may result in volcanic eruptions**
- **earthquake activity may occur/ friction**

(ii) Explain **two** strategies which a country might use to help it recover from a major earthquake.

This question was very challenging to candidates, most candidates failed to score marks. They missed the key words, instead of recovery strategies, they wrote preparation strategies e.g. building reinforced structures to avoid destruction, educating people on what to do during an earthquake. There was rare reference to recovery strategies directed to environmental impacts of earthquakes.

Expected responses:

- **Reconstruction of damaged infrastructure – construction of reinforced houses, bridges and roads.**
- **Resettlement of people – relocation of people to safe areas**
- **Rebuilding economic strength – through financial aid to compensate those who lost their properties.**
- **Restoring power- for smooth operation**
- **Stress debriefing for emergency responders and victims.**

- **Rebuilding social stability/ provision of medical supplies/food supplies/shelter/counselling- development to be relevant to point stated.**
- **Restore damaged ecosystems- replanting of trees.**

(c) Natural disasters such as earthquakes need people to be prepared for them. For a country you have studied, suggest **three** measures that could be used to prepare for earthquakes to reduce the impacts.

This question was generally well answered. Most candidates wrote relevant responses on preparation of earthquake such as reinforced buildings with shock absorbers, training search and rescue teams, relocation and warning instruments. However, some candidates wrote irrelevant responses such as watching animal behavior, and building strong houses without referring to reinforcement thus loss of marks. Some responses were poorly developed such as building of houses that can withstand earthquakes instead of being specific on how the buildings are constructed

Expected responses:

Country – Japan, Indonesia, USA, Alaska, China, etc.

- **Monitoring and warning instruments / hazard mapping – to notify people so that they can evacuate the area/ for prediction of future earthquakes**
- **Reinforced buildings/Rubber shock absorbers in building foundations/ use of steel – to be flexible and withstand the shocks**
- **Earthquake drills/Educate people – on what to do in the event of an earthquake**
- **Provision /Train search and rescue teams – for searching survivors from the rubble**
- **Organise emergency services – to provide water, food/ medical supplies, after the earthquake.**
- **Water and gas pipes designed to shut off automatically/ made from flexible materials – to prevent flooding and fires**
- **Buildings fitted with computer sensors – to detect ground vibrations/ seismic waves.**
- **Sea walls are constructed along the coast lines – to protect communities from tsunamis**
- **Resettlement/ Evacuations/ relocation – to reduce the number of deaths and injuries**

Question 2

(a) Fig. 3 shows the climate of a place in a region of hot desert.

(i) Define a *climatic region*.

Most candidates failed to answer this question, instead they defined climate or climate change. Some failed to refer to large area and climatic features.

Expected response:

(A continuous geographic) area in which similar climate characteristics are observed/ an area with similar average temperatures and rainfall

(ii) Using information from Fig. 3, state:

A the average temperature for the month of February

B the average rainfall for the month of May

Most candidates were able to use the resource and answer the question properly using the correct units. Some candidates had a challenge with reading the temperature graph often stated as 30°C

Expected responses:

A the average temperature for the month of February – **32°C**

B the average rainfall for the month of May – **4mm**

(iii) Describe the distribution of rainfall shown in Fig. 3.

Candidates were unable to describe distribution using proper terms. They used a lot of rainfall instead of highest, most were unable to describe November as the lowest rainfall. Candidates also failed to identify the months of the year indicated on the graph, for example candidates stated, there was high rainfall in the first month instead of highest rainfall in January. They even wrote the months using alphabets like J instead of January. Some candidates wrote the rainfall amounts for each individual month and wrote temperature figures or compared the relationship between rainfall and temperature, which was not a requirement of the question.

Expected responses:

- **High/ Highest in January**
- **Lowest in November**
- **Summer rain/ seasonal rainfall/ unevenly distributed**
- **Winter dry / seasonal rainfall/ unevenly distributed**

- **Absent during the months of June, July and August /no rainfall**
- **Low annual rainfall/ low throughout the year**

(iv) Describe **four** factors which lead to low rainfall in hot desert climatic regions.

Candidates were unable to answer this question, so it was poorly done. They were unable to describe factors which lead to low rainfall such as cold ocean currents, high pressure wind system, distance from the sea, instead they wrote the general factors that influence climate or temperature like humidity, cloud cover and altitude.

Expected responses:

- **Effects of off-shore Trade Winds/global air patterns**
- **Effect of dry Westerly winds**
- **Rain shadow effects**
- **High pressure system/ descending winds**
- **Influence of latitude (Equator and Tropics)**
- **Distance from the sea**
- **Cold ocean currents**

(b) Study Photograph **A** (Insert), which was taken in a tropical hot desert.

(i) Describe **four** features of the vegetation shown in Photograph **A**.

This question was poorly done, candidates failed to identify features of vegetation from the picture such as dry grass, scattered trees, short trees instead wrote the general features of the vegetation and the landscape in hot deserts e.g. tap roots, the sandy soil and low rainfall.

Expected responses:

- **few/ scattered trees/ little vegetation/sparse**
- **dry/ short (tufted) grass/ withered**
- **short shrubs/bushes/ leafless trees**
- **pale colour/ khaki/ brown**

(ii) Explain **two** challenges faced by people who live in hot deserts.

This question was fairly done. Candidates were able to identify challenges such as high temperatures and little rainfall. However, they failed to develop the identified point instead

repeated little rainfall. Some candidates failed to write the correct terms such as high temperatures and wrote hot temperatures and less or no rainfall instead of little rainfall.

Expected responses:

- **High temperatures – causing health problems like heatstroke/ heat exhaustion/worsening medical conditions like kidney and lung diseases**
- **Little rainfall – shortage of water supply for domestic /agricultural /industrial purposes**
- **inaccessibility – sandy/rocky desert soils make road construction difficult**
- **sandstorms – reduce visibility/damage to property/risk to life/ impedes communications**
- **salt/mobile/infertile soil – makes farming difficult causing food shortages**

(c) Human interference has an impact on natural regions.

For an example of a tropical rainforest region you have studied, suggest **three negative** impacts of human interference on the tropical rainforest.

This question was fairly done. Most candidates were able to identify the impacts of human interference e.g. soil erosion, deforestation. However, they failed to explain the identified impacts in relation to human interference. Some repeated the same point e.g. deforestation and stated different reasons. Most candidates failed to provide an example of a tropical rainforest.

Expected responses:

Example – Amazon basin, Congo/Zaire basin, Indonesia, Malaysia, etc.

- **Deforestation – as forest are cleared for different purposes such as lumbering**
- **Loss of habitat for wild animals-- resulting to wild animals becoming extinct/ due to road construction**
- **Global warming – as forests that act as carbon sinks are cleared for farming**
- **Soil erosion- where clearings for shifting cultivation are abandoned.**
- **Loss of flora and fauna- as forest are cleared thus both become extinct.**
- **Water pollution – due to agricultural runoff/ use of pesticides/industrial activities.**

Question 3

(a) Study Photograph **B** (Insert) which shows a subsistence farm.

(i) Define *subsistence farming*.

Well attempted, with many candidates defining the term fully. However, there were few candidates who focused on one aspect of subsistence farming i.e. either arable or pastoral yet they had to mention both.

Expected response:

It is the growing of crops and keeping/rearing of livestock for family consumption.

(ii) List **two** inputs of the subsistence farm shown in Photograph **B**.

Most candidates were able to identify at least one correct input from the photograph. Weaker responses listed items not shown in the photograph or confused inputs with outputs. Some candidates repeated the same idea using different wording, limiting the marks awarded.

Expected responses:

- **Draught animals/span of oxen**
- **Land/soil.**
- **Family labour**
- **Plough/Yoke**
- **Seeds**

(iii) Identify **three** characteristics of the subsistence farm shown in Photograph **B**.

Many candidates correctly identified relevant characteristics. However, some responses lacked precision or repeated similar points. In some cases, candidates provided general farming features without clearly linking them to subsistence farming or the stimulus provided.

Expected responses:

- **Small piece of land cultivated**
- **Family labour used/unskilled labour**
- **Sowing of seeds by hand**
- **Simple tools are used/ ox-drawn plough**
- **Farms are unfenced.**

- (iv) Describe **four** problems faced by subsistence arable farmers.

Overall performance on this part was satisfactory, though there were some candidates who were describing problems faced by subsistence pastoral farmers which did not score.

Expected responses:

- **Hailstorms/Unreliable rainfall / drought / floods**
- **Infertile soils**
- **Pests and diseases**
- **Lack of information/ lack of skills**
- **Little arable land**
- **Lack of use of hybrid treated seeds**
- **Lack of capital to buy artificial inputs/ high cost of inputs (fertilizers)**
- **Lack of machinery,**
- **Insecure land tenure.**
- **Poor storage**
- **Wild animals /theft**

- (b) Study Fig. 4, which shows the distribution of areas affected by drought, a major cause of food shortages.

- (i) Describe the distribution of areas affected by drought in Fig. 4.

Most candidates were unable to describe distribution of areas affected by drought. Common errors included referring to tectonic plates instead of continents, incorrect compass direction, and inclusion of irrelevant information. Teachers are advised to emphasise careful reading of questions and precise use of compass points/direction and continents. Reference to North and South America as America was common.

Expected responses:

- **Western part of North America/ South western part**
- **Western part of South America**
- **Northern part of Africa**
- **South-western part of Africa**
- **Central parts of Eurasia**

- **Central part of Australia/ Western Australia**
- **South/central part of South America**
- **Middle East/ South west of Eurasia**

(ii) Explain **two** effects of food shortages on the people living in LEDCs.

Most candidates identified appropriate effects of food shortages. However, explanations were often underdeveloped, with some responses remaining descriptive rather than explanatory.

Expected responses:

- **Outbreak of diseases/e.g. kwashiorkor/marasmus especially among young children - due to malnutrition**
- **Country's reliance on donors for things like food aid e.g. rice from Taiwan and yellow maize from USA- strings attached/ political influence**
- **Famine – which may result to increased death rate**
- **Increased food priced – due to scarcity and high demand/ increased poverty**
- **Increased international migration – for greener pastures**
- **Economic decline – increased expenditure on food imports/ due to low productivity**
- **Social ills/ Social unrest – as people compete for scarce food reserves**

(c) Food shortages mostly affect LEDCs.

For an area you have studied, suggest solutions to the problems of food shortages.

Many candidates suggested relevant solutions, but some candidates failed to explain how the suggested measures would reduce food shortages. Stronger candidates contextualised their responses and showed understanding of sustainable solutions.

Expected responses:

- **By irrigation – to extend the crop growing season**
- **Application of artificial fertilizer – to increase soil fertility**
- **Use of hybrid seeds – that are resistant to harsh climatic conditions/quickly ripen**
- **Use of agro chemicals/herbicides/pesticides – to destroy pests/diseases**
- **Use of machinery – makes it possible to plough large land thus increasing yields.**

- **Education/ Skilled labour / Use of scientific knowledge – to improve output through GMOs/ greenhouse systems/ improved farming methods**
- **Invest more capital – to be able to buy more inputs**
- **Food Aid/ import food from other countries – to supplement local produce/ food supplies**
- **Government must control basic food prices/ government subsidies – to make food affordable for consumers/ to make inputs affordable**
- **Enhancing efficient food storage/ distribution – to ensure access by vulnerable groups.**

General comments on question 4

This question was unpopular, despite that most candidates who chose it were able to score satisfactory marks (with an exception of sub question a part iv, which seemed to be challenging).

Question 4

(a) Study Fig. 5, which shows some features of the tourist industry in part of southern Africa.

(i) Define a *tourist*.

The question was well attempted as most candidates were able to define the term.

Expected response:

A person who visits a country/ place (temporarily) for leisure/pleasure/ holiday / business

(ii) Describe the distribution of the game parks in Botswana shown in Fig. 5.

Most candidates failed to describe distribution as they could not to use cardinal points/compass points.

Expected responses:

- **Central Botswana**
- **North of Botswana/ NE of Botswana**
 - **Southwest of Botswana**

- (iii) Using Fig. 5, identify **three** features that make Hwange National Park a well-placed attraction for international tourists.

This question was poorly attempted; proximity was key in answering the question.

Expected responses:

- **Near main road/easily accessible**
- **Near international airport**
- **Near other attractions like Lake Kariba, Victoria Falls**
- **Near the motel**
- **Backpackers lodge nearby**
- **Near town**
- **Near/closer to the international boundary**

- (iv) Describe **four** features of ecotourism.

This was the most challenging sub question as most candidates failed to describe the features of eco-tourism. Candidates were extracting their responses from the photograph given as Fig 6., yet this was required in b (i).

Expected responses:

- **Low impact of visitors' behaviour especially on the environment**
- **Sensitivity to local culture**
- **Supports local conservation efforts/biodiversity**
- **Local participation and decision making**
- **Sustainable benefit to local communities**

- (b) Study Fig. 6 (Insert), which shows tourist attractions in Eswatini.

- (i) Identify the **four** tourist attractions shown in Fig. 6.

Most candidates correctly identified attractions shown in the figure.

Expected responses:

- **handicraft**
- **horse riding**
- **wildlife/ game reserve/ wild animals/ giraffes/ natural vegetation**
- **Umhlanga/ reed dance/ cultural event**

- (ii) Explain **two** positive impacts of tourism on the local people.

Many candidates identified valid positive impacts of tourism. However, explanations were often limited, with some candidates listing impacts without showing how tourism contributes to these benefits.

Expected responses:

- **Job opportunities- provides employment improving the living standard of the people**
- **Skills acquisition- to be able to open their own businesses**
- **Handicraft products – may be sold to earn income**
- **Local business strengthened- by supplying food to hotels**
- **Improved infrastructure and services- that are developed to encourage more tourist**
- **Increased GD/ boosts the economy- it is a source of foreign exchange/ brings money to the country through taxes**
- **Creates awareness of traditional / cultural practices – helps preserve local traditions**

- (c) Tourism has negative impacts on the people and the environment. For an area you have studied, suggest **three** mitigation measures to reduce the negative impacts of tourism.
- Most candidates failed to score on this question, they were explaining problems caused by tourism instead of suggesting solutions to the problems.

Expected responses:

Example – Durban, Ezulwini, etc.

- Routine cleans up – to reduce waste management problems
- Litter / Clean-up campaign/ plenty litter collection bins/ machinery – to reduce pollution
- Location of tourist activities – away from sensitive sites
- Public education – on conservation of the environment
- Sewage treatment plants – for sewage disposal
- Park and ride – to ease traffic congestion to tourist sites.
- High cost, low volume – to reduce the number of visitors/ tourists while keeping the income the same
- Increased security – to reduce the high crime rate in tourist spots
- Ecotourism – to ensure protection of the environment against environmental degradation
- Government policy – enacting laws to protect against environmental degradation (accept example of government policy)

Question 5

- (a) Study Fig. 7, which shows a sketch map (**not to scale**) of a rural area and four proposed sites **A, B, C** and **D** for the location of a new village.

- (i) Define a settlement *site*.

This question was challenging to most candidates as a majority provided a settlement definition or define situation of a settlement rather than settlement site.

Expected response:

Ground where a settlement stands/is built/ actual point where a settlement is located

- (ii) State **two** reasons why site **B** was chosen as the best location for the village.

This question was generally well answered. Most candidates correctly identified the reasons.

Expected response:

- **Tarred road/ motor able track/ Availability of route ways/transport**
- **(Rich) fertile soils**
- **Availability of a river/water supply**
- **low altitude/gentle sloping land**

- (iii) Giving a different reason in each case, state why the other three sites were rejected.

The question was well done. Most candidates correctly identified the reasons for the rejection of the sites even though a few failed to interpret the contour lines, so they wrote contours instead of steep slope.

Expected responses:

A – steep / mountainous/ high altitude/ difficult to construct on steep slopes

C – marshy / houses will sink

D – forested / high cost of clearing forest plantation

- (iv) Describe **four** functions of rural settlements.

This question was poorly done; candidates could not identify the functions of a rural settlement. Most could only identify only farming. Those who gave correct responses ended repeating similar answers.

Expected responses:

- **Transportation**
- **Water supply**
- **Residential**
- **Shopping**
- **community based tourism**
- **basic economic activities (farming/ forestry/fishing etc) Max 2**
- **Social services – (education/religion/security/health) Max 2**

- (b) Study Fig.8, which shows different goods and services provided by a settlement.

- (i) Identify the following in Fig. 8

The question was fairly done, a majority of candidates were able to score maximum marks. Some candidates could not differentiate between a low and high threshold population; hence they mixed up the responses.

Expected responses:

A **two** goods or services that have a low range – **bread/vegetable shop/green grocery/ market**

B a good or service that has a large sphere of influence but low threshold population – **motor car / car dealership**

C a good or service that has a large sphere of influence and a high threshold population – **stadium/ sports ground/ recreation**

- (ii) Explain **two** factors that influence the size of the sphere of influence of a settlement.

This question was challenging to the candidates. Most candidates gave factors influencing the location of rural settlements instead of sphere of influence, this indicated that they failed to comprehend the meaning of sphere of influence but identified factors influencing the siting of a settlement, e.g. water supply.

Expected responses:

- **Size of settlement - large settlement with many services = large sphere of influence**
- **Size of population – smaller services leading to smaller sphere of influence.**
- **Relief - mountains or marsh = low population density =smaller sphere of influence**
- **Income levels - more wealth = more services, outlets = larger sphere of influence**
- **Accessibility – availability of transport = large sphere of influence**
- **Competition from other settlements – nearby towns may offer the same services/goods = smaller sphere of influence. (isolated larger sphere of influence)**
- **Types of goods and services – high order have larger sphere of influence**

- (c) One of the impacts of the growth of urban areas is the development of satellite towns. For an area you have studied, suggest **three** positive impacts of satellite towns on the people.

This was a challenging question, most candidates misinterpreted the question, their responses were based on satellite dishes instead of towns e.g. they responded that they would enjoy uninterrupted network, enjoy watching TV channels, job opportunities etc. Hence, they also failed to provide suitable examples.

Expected responses:

Example – Waco for Dallas in Texas, Matola for Maputo in Mozambique, Matsapha for Manzini, Ezulwini for Mbabane, Sidvokodvo for Manzini, Sandton for Johannesburg

- **Variety of goods and services – wide choice for goods and services**
- **Provision of jobs – standard of living be improved / due to development of businesses etc.**
- **Development of infrastructure – like roads which can be used by locals**
- **Cheaper land values – the cost of land is low compared to that of large towns.**
- **Reduced cost of living – prices of goods are low.**
- **Availability of land – more spacious land is available**
- **Stronger sense of local community – more connected to people around you.**
- **Ease of access/closer to residential area – due to lack of traffic congestion/ free flow of traffic/ reduced costs of travelling to town.**

Question 6

(a) Study Fig. 9 which is an extract about the population of Lesotho.

Define *overpopulation*.

The question was well answered, candidates correctly defined overpopulation.

Expected response:

- **When people are more than available resources**

(i) State **two** reasons for the population distribution in Lesotho.

Faily done as most candidates scored at least one mark. However, some failed to interpret the given resource i.e. common response was along the Caledon River instead of water supply from the Caledon River.

Expected responses:

- **Gentle sloping terrain on the Western side / rugged terrain on the East**
- **Water supply from the Caledon River**

(ii) Using evidence from Fig. 9 only, describe **three** features which show that Lesotho is overpopulated.

Candidates did well in this question. They were able to describe the features as stated in the extract.

Expected responses:

- **Insufficient resources/ few mines and industries**
- **Little arable land/ reduced per capita**
- **High number of migrant labourers to South Africa/ lack of job opportunities in Lesotho**
- **Imports from South Africa**
- **Unsustainable agricultural practises/ overgrazing**

(iii) Describe **four** solutions to overpopulation in countries such as Lesotho.

This question was poorly answered by candidates. Most candidates restricted themselves on solutions to high birth rate in their responses e.g. free contraceptives, implementing population policies, they could only score a maximum of 2 marks, thus failing to describe other solutions.

Expected responses:

- **Birth control (Promote family planning) Max 2 on birth control measures**
- **Women empowerment/ gender equity**
- **Raise awareness of reproductive health issues/ education**
- **Legislation/policies on number of children**
- **Free access to birth control**
- **Improve farming methods**
- **Use of alternative energy sources**
- **Improve health care to reduce infant mortality**
- **Increase job opportunities**

(b) Study Fig. 10, which shows regions from which African migrants are emigrating.

(i) Describe **four** migration trends of migration shown in Fig. 10. Do not use figures in your answer.

Candidates had a challenge with this question. They were unable to describe migration trends. Instead, they were comparing the rate of emigrants between two regions, some described the number of migrants per year. They failed to use the correct geographic terms to describe change e.g. rapid increase, gradual increase, fluctuating etc. A few candidates did not understand the meaning of the word trend which simply referred to the pattern.

Expected responses:

- **Emigration is highest in West Africa**
- **Emigration is lowest in Central Africa**
- **High rate of increase in East Africa and West Africa**
- **Great increase in East Africa from 1995 to 2020**
- **Central Africa slight increase from 1995 to 2020**
- **Central Africa declined in 2005, increased slightly in 2020/ fluctuates**
- **North Africa gradual increase from 1995 to 2015/ From 2015 to 2020**
- **Southern Africa gradual increase from 1995 to 2020**
- **General increase from 1995 to 2020.**

- (ii) Explain **two** strategies for reducing the rate of migration.

Fairly attempted, candidates were able to identify the strategies for reducing the rate of migration but were unable to link it to the question through the development of the points. Most candidates were repeating the stem of the question as their development.

Expected responses:

- **Government policy – provision of factory shells in rural areas**
- **Decentralisation – moving services to regional centres**
- **Satellite towns – to ease congestion in major towns and cities**
- **(Rural) industrialization – construction of industries to provide employment**
- **Providing incentives – subsidised farming inputs to keep the farmers engaged in agriculture**
- **Improvement of services in rural areas– construction of hospitals, shopping centres, schools and tarred roads**
- **Strengthening border security/ VISA – to restrict immigrants**

- (c) Population distribution is influenced by a number of factors. For a country you have studied, suggest how **three physical** factors influence population distribution.

Fairly done. Most candidates correctly identified the factors such as gentle sloping land, fertile soils etc. However, they failed to relate these factors to population distribution e.g. Areas that are gentle sloping are densely populated because it becomes easier to construct settlements. Some candidates however still wrote human factors such as well-developed roads instead of physical factors, which was irrelevant.

Expected responses:

- **Soils** – More people are attracted to areas with fertile soils where there is greater productivity (it can support a larger population)
 - **Climate (temperature and rainfall)** – More people are found in areas with favourable climatic conditions where they can grow crops.
 - **Water supply** – more people are found in areas where water is available for irrigation purposes and domestic use.
 - **Relief/ Land** - people are found where the slope is gentle as they are able to construct their houses/ practice farming
 - **Aspect** – sun facing slopes have high population densities because they are warmer and sunny which promotes farming and settlements
 - **Natural vegetation** –more people will settle where there is availability of building materials/ source of fuel.
- (Allow opposite approach)**

Paper 6890/02

Paper 2 is structured as follows:

- **Section A:** One compulsory question based on a topographical map
- **Section B:** Compulsory skills-based questions 2,3 and 4) using a variety of geographical sources
- **Section C:** Candidates must answer **either Question 5 or Question 6**

This paper assesses candidates' ability to interpret, analyse and apply geographical skills, including the use of maps, photographs, diagrams, graphs, tables and basic enquiry techniques. Questions are location-neutral, allowing candidates to demonstrate transferable geographical skills rather than place-specific knowledge.

Key Messages for Candidates and Teachers in Centres

1. Map Skills and Interpretation

- Candidates must study the map carefully before answering. Looking beyond the immediate area in question often helps in understanding relief, drainage patterns and land use, particularly when interpreting contour lines and heights.
- The map key is essential and should be consulted regularly to ensure accurate identification of symbols, features and land uses.
- Candidates should avoid assuming that all possible features occur at the same location. For example, mining features may be shown as prospecting trench, mine dump or quarry – not all three at once the wording in the key is separated by commas however the symbols follow each other in the order of the wording across.
- Precision is required when referring to physical features, natural features, human features, facilities and services. Candidates must ensure they are addressing the correct category.
- Contours do not just show height – they show the shape, steepness and direction of the land, and these must always be interpreted together, not separately. Changes in contour spacing indicate changes in slope gradient and landform shape.

2. Use of Command Words

- Candidates should read questions carefully and identify the command word (e.g. *describe, explain, suggest, compare, justify*).
- Responses must match the demand of the question.
 - *Describe* → state what is visible or evident
 - *Explain* → give reasons
 - *Suggest* → apply geographical understanding
 - *Compare* → show similarities and differences using paired data

3. Comparison and Data Handling

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- When comparing data, candidates must:
 - Use comparative language such as *higher than, lower than, greater, less*.
 - Use paired data (both sides of the comparison) unless otherwise stated in the question (see Question 3. (a)(ii))
- Candidates should avoid copying figures directly from sources without interpretation. Analysis and interpretation are core skills in this paper.

4. Use of Sources (Photographs, Graphs, Tables and Diagrams)

- Candidates must ensure they are using the correct source(s) specified in the question.
- In photograph-based questions, answers must be based strictly on visible evidence, not speculation about what cannot be seen.
- In photograph analysis questions, candidates must track changes in both sources within the given period to score. (see Question 1(m))
- Successful responses clearly link observations from the source to the question being asked.
- When interpreting graphs and tables, candidates should:
 - Read axes and units carefully
 - Extract accurate values.
 - Use data to support statements rather than making general comments. (see Question 4. (a), (ii), (iii) and 4. (b)(i), (ii))

5. Process and Method Questions

- When describing a process or method, candidates must follow the correct chronological order.
- Clear sequencing improves clarity and ensures marks are awarded for logical progression. (See Question 1. (k))

Area is: total number of full squares+ part squares/2

Then answer multiplied by 1Km²

6. Hypotheses and Enquiry Skills

- In hypotheses questions, candidates must:
 - State their opinion clearly first / Taking a stand or declarative statement (True, untrue, false, correct, incorrect agree or disagree).
 - Support the decision with evidence from the given data.
- Conclusions such as *"partially agree"* or *"agree to some extent"* are not acceptable in this component.
- Candidates should not copy the hypothesis as their answer, even if they agree with it.

7. Examination Technique and Presentation

- All parts of each question should be attempted, especially those linked directly to provided data.
- Candidates must:
 - Write numbers clearly, especially digits
 - Include units where required (e.g. mm, °C, km, cm, millions)

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- Graph plotting should be done using a sharp pencil to ensure accuracy and neat corrections.
- Candidates must follow instructions carefully, particularly by answering only one question in Section C.

General Comments

The number of candidates increased from approximately 9013 in 2024 to just over 10, 000 in 2025, although some centres continue to register very low candidate numbers, which remains a concern.

- Section B performance was generally weak across many centres, indicating gaps in key geographical skills.
- Many candidates struggled with:
 - Interpreting illustrations for a day's weather forecast.
 - Plotting graphs on birth rates and life expectancy at birth and establishing a relationship between the two.
 - Distinguishing a decline, or increase that is steady, gradual, sharp.
 - Defining life expectancy and to suggest reasons for low life expectancy in LEDCs
- Basic calculation skills involving population data (births per thousands) were insufficient in some centres.
- These weaknesses suggest a need for greater emphasis on practical skills, regular practice with real examination-style resources, and explicit engagement on data interpretation techniques.

Comments on specific questions

SECTION A: MAP READING

This section was broadly comparable in standard to previous examination sessions. However, four key areas of concern were noted, namely the interpretation of gradient, the identification of plantation farming features, the tracking of changes over time in the map area shown in Fig.5 and Photograph A (Insert) and the calculation of area. Difficulties in these areas limited the ability of otherwise able candidates to achieve higher marks, with many failing to progress well beyond 20 out of the available 25 marks.

There were, however, some excellent responses to Question 1, particularly from centres that had, seemingly, allocated sufficient time to preparing candidates in the calculation of area, gradient interpretation, and the analysis of aerial photographs.

Question 1

The map extract is for Glendale (Zimbabwe). The scale is 1:50 000.

Fig. 1 shows the position of some features in the central part of the map.

(a) Identify the following features shown in Fig. 1:

(i) feature A

This part question was generally well done however some candidates confused the symbol for a bridge instead of dip tank.

Expected response: Dip tank

(ii) land use at B;

Generally, this part question was well done even though some candidates gave cultivations which did not score since it has a different shade, symbol in the map legend.

Expected response: Orchard / Plantation

(iii) feature C;

This was fairly well done however some candidates gave incomplete responses leaving out 'ponds'

Expected response: Sewage ponds

(iv) type of road D;

It was fairly well done however some candidates referred to it as a Narrow tarred road

Expected response: Wide tarred road

(v) river feature E;

A majority of the candidates found this question accessible.

Expected response: Dam

(vi) land use at F;

This part question was fairly well done even though some candidates had difficulty to read the key correctly mistaking built up area and building to mean the same.

Expected response: Built- up area.

(b) Name the feature that is located at grid reference 906748

Except for the incorrect spelling the part question was well done.

Expected response: Reservoir

(c) Identify two recreational facilities found in the town of Glendale.

Except for those that confused recreational facilities for social services like school, church, clinic etc it was fairly well done.

Expected responses:

- Golf course
- Sports field
- Club

- (d) A tourist standing at the trigonometrical station (9874) on top of the mountain range can see town of Glendale.**

State the general direction the tourist is looking.

The direction was correctly spotted by most candidates

Expected response: North- West.

- (e) Measure the whole circle bearing of the trigonometrical station at 9874 from the spot height**

Though some candidates' measurement fell outside the acceptable angle range, probably due to lack of practice on placing a protractor, a majority of centres gave impressive answers.

Expected response: 152°

- (f) Measure the distance along the tarred road in metres from the spot height at 9685 to the spot height at 0089.**

This was a done fairly well question except for those candidates that left their answers in km.

Expected response: 5600m

- (g) Calculate the average gradient of the narrow tarred road between the spot height 9685 and the spot height 0089.**

It was quite challenging for a majority of candidates. Attributed to the following if HE from (f) was incorrect it wouldn't be possible to score for both marks in this part question, on another note some candidates got the VI as – 6 hence failed to score.

Expected response: VI/ HE = 6 / 5600

1: 933

- (h) Study Fig.2 which shows an area on the map where there is a plantation or orchard. Identify two features of the plantation farming shown.**

Another question that proved challenging and demanding to candidates yet a plantation may have distinctive features since it is a human feature, therefore natural features failed to score.

Expected response:

- Staff quarters
- Buildings
- Furrows
- Other roads

(i) Identify the settlement pattern shown in grid square 9780.

The settlement pattern was well identified by most candidates except for a few that confused settlement with drainage patterns.

Expected response:

Linear

(j) State one reason for the development of this pattern of settlement.

The observation in this part question is candidates opted to give factors influencing linear settlement development, yet in this particular part question, a river, a road or foot of a hill could not score.

Expected response: Railway line as a route

(k) Study Fig. 3 which shows part of Laurencedale Estate.

Using Fig. 3 calculate the total area of the estate shown.

One of the most challenging part questions to candidates in this question.

Some candidates that didn't do well could hardly count full squares if they did they took a sum of full and part squares divided by 2.

Expected response:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Area} &= \text{total number of full squares} + \text{total number of part squares}/2 \\
 &= 8 + 16/2 \\
 &= 16 \times 1\text{km}^2 \\
 &= 16 \text{ km}^2
 \end{aligned}$$

(l) Fig.4 shows a gravel road south of Virginia South Extension.

Which one of the physical features has made it possible for the road to be constructed?

Tick (✓) the correct answer.

Physical feature	Tick (✓)
Mountain pass	✓
Gorge	
Cliff	

This part question seemed fair yet it was poorly done, a majority of candidates ticked two boxes instead of one. Moreover, the ticks were made on what could be barriers in road construction yet the correct response gave an idea on the word “pass”

Expected response: Mountain pass

- (m) Study Fig.5 which shows part of the map where aerial photograph A (Insert) was taken. The map was produced in 1987; photograph A was taken in 2022.**

This part was the most challenging of all the part questions, in Question 1. Most candidates failed to relate the map features and that of the photograph shown. It should be noted that superimposing the two was made impossible by unequal scales the photograph was blown up to reveal changes thus appeared larger. Candidates lacked the idea of juxtaposing the two to identify differences between 1987 and 2022. The question was about changes observed when analysing both sources over the years, which was lacking from most centres.

Expected responses:

- Farmlands replaced by settlement
- Medium bush cleared for farming
- Glendale fuel station had now been established (2022)
- Farms (new) developed along the river
- Cultivations replaced by circular fields
- A dam constructed along Mazowe river

SECTION B

Question 2

- (a) Study Photograph B (Insert), which shows part of an automated weather station.**
(i) Define a *digital weather station*.

The definition of a digital weather station was reduced to that of a simple weather station by most candidates. Those that attempted a different approach used the words in the stem of the part question which could not score and thus poorly attempted.

Expected responses:

An electronic computerised device that records weather information/technology used to record weather information or weather elements.

- (ii) State any two weather elements that are represented by the data displayed in the screen.**

A majority of candidates poorly attempted this part question. Instead of weather elements they gave weather instruments while others gave elements not shown in the screen. Wind as an element could not score since there was no indication of the aspect of wind as an element.

Expected response:

- Rainfall/ Rain
- Wind speed
- Wind direction
- Air temperature
- Atmospheric Pressure
- Relative Humidity
- Cloud cover

(iii) Identify the parts labelled A and B

Most candidates could not identify the instrument displayed in the digital weather station (Photograph B) instead they picked parts of the whole instruments such as tail/ paddle for both the wind vane or cup anemometer which could not score

Expected responses: A Cup Anemometer

B Wind vane

(b) Study Fig.6 which shows a five-day weather forecast for an area.

(i) Describe the weather forecast for Sunday.

Most candidates gave impressive responses on this part question except for those who made a description without making a forecast for the day in question Sunday.

Expected responses:

- cloudy/ thick clouds
- Rainy/ raining /showers/accompanied by rain
- lightning / thunder / thunderstorm
- warm to hot temperatures /23°C

(ii) Study Fig. 7, which is a graph showing the changes in temperatures over the same five-day period

Use Fig.6 to complete Fig. 7 by plotting the predicted temperature for Tuesday.

A majority plotted correctly except for a few who marked the plotting in-between Monday and Tuesday.

Question 3

(a) **Study Fig. 8 which shows the distribution of water use in different countries.**

(i) **Use table.1 to plot the information for Mali on Fig. 8**

Country	Agriculture (%)	Domestic (%)	Industry (%)
Mali	90	9	1

Most candidates failed to plot the information for Mali on the triangular graph those that managed left a dot without labelling the country Mali as the other countries shown.

Expected response: A correct plotting using a dot for Mali at the apex (top) triangle bottom right.

(ii) **Describe the differences in water use between UK and India.**

This part question was fairly well done. However, some candidates failed to score by comparing dissimilar water uses between India and the UK

Expected response:

Water usage by %	India	UK
Agriculture	Higher	Lower
Domestic	Lower	Higher
Industry	Lower	Higher

(iii) **Suggest two reasons why the use of water varies in different countries.**

A majority of candidates performed poorly in this part question, and their responses were vague.

Expected responses:

- The level of development / industrialisation if higher use is higher
- Unequal availability of water in countries (some are well endowed as compared to others)
- Population size the higher invariably determines higher demand
- Higher dependence on agriculture and more domestic uses increases the water demand.

(b) **State two uses of water in industries**

This part question was fairly well done. Some candidates failed to score by ignoring industry in the stem of the question.

Expected responses:

- Processing / raw material
- Cooling machinery/ cleaning

- Washing of machinery / products
- HEP generation
- Irrigation purposes
- Domestically by workers on site.
- Recreation such as in tourism.

Question 4

(a) Study Fig. 9 which shows the relationship between the birth-rates and the life expectancy at birth for some countries

(i) Define *life expectancy*.

A majority of candidates failed to score in the definition by leaving out the word 'average' or use of the phrase 'supposed to live' instead of 'expected to live'.

Expected response:

The average number of years a person / individual is expected to live from birth.

(ii) Eswatini has a birth rate of 24 per 1000 and a life expectancy at birth of 61years. Plot this information on Fig. 9.

The plotting by most candidates was marred by a lot of inconsistencies. Some who did manage to plot correctly didn't label the country Eswatini next to the dot while some put a cross instead of a dot.

Expected response:

Correct plotting was on the main grid between births per 1000 people vertical lines 20 and 25 and life expectancy at birth horizontal lines 60 and 65. At the top left corner of the south western corner of the mini square.

(iii) What type of relationship between the birth rate and the life expectancy at birth is shown Fig.9

It seemed this question was inaccessible to most candidates who failed to establish a trend in terms of the two variables on the graph

Expected response:

It is a negative relationship/correlation / as one increases the other decreases/or inversely proportional.

(iv) Suggest three reasons why life expectancy at birth is low in EDCs

Most candidates were failed by thinking the question was intending to elicit responses on causes of low birth rates instead of low life expectancy which could not score.

Expected responses:

- Poverty/ poor standard of living / a physically hard life
- Lack of clean water
- Shortage of food/malnutrition/starvation/poor diets
- Increased diseases /higher spread of diseases
- Homelessness/poor shelter
- More prone to natural disasters
- Poor medical care/ supplies/fewer health facilities.
- High infant mortality rate
- Lack of social security.

(b) Study Fig. 10, which shows the changes in Chinas birth rate between 1979 and 2020.

(i) Calculate the change in birth rates between 1979and 2016.

Most candidates managed to perform the calculation correctly they got the units wrongly thus failed to score.

18 - 13 = 5 live births per thousand

(ii) Identify from Fig.10 the period when the birth rates declined the most. Tick (✓) the correct box.

This part question was fairly well done with most candidates recognizing the period that experienced a marked decline of the three.

Expected response:

1990 – 2000

(iii) Use Fig. 10 to describe the effect of the two child-policy introduced in 2016 on birth rates.

Instead of describing the effect on the birth rates, most candidates were describing the effect on the total population hence failed to score.

Expected response:

It was ineffective, thus birth rate continued decreasing/reduced/ lowered/dropped declined.

SECTION C: RESEARCH

In this section, the candidates answer **either Question 5 or Question 6**. Question 5 was more accessible than Question 6 although both questions were attempted reasonably well

Question 5

In the overall this proved to be the most accessible and popular question of the two questions, and as such candidates that scored higher marks in this section were those that chose this question.

Students carried out a fieldwork on industries. They conducted a survey in Matsapha industrial area.

The students agreed to investigate two hypotheses:

Hypothesis 1: *The industrial area has an impact on the quality of water in the local river.*

Hypothesis 2: *The industrial area has more negative than positive impacts on the people.*

(a) During the planning the students decided to do a preliminary visit to the industrial area.

(i) Suggest three reasons why the students carried out a preliminary visit.

A majority of candidates were able to give reasons for carrying out a preliminary visit showing an understanding for preparation in a research study. Those that failed to score were giving general responses without being specific to the survey in the industrial area.

Expected response:

- To familiarise themselves with the area
- For timing activities during the actual investigation/ duration
- To check feasibility of investigation in the area
- To choose sites for the investigation / suitability
- To identify relevant safety measures
- To test out the equipment in readiness for the main survey.
- To save time on the actual day of investigation.

(ii) During the preliminary visit the students visited the local town offices to request a map of the industrial area Fig.11(Insert).

State one advantage of using a map during a survey.

Most candidates failed to state the advantages of using a map in carrying out the survey, a few emphasised on the general usage of a map i.e. to locate features.

Expected responses:

- To help plan and design fieldwork
- To help select fieldwork sites/routes
- To help locate places/ features
- To estimate distances using scale
- To save time

(b) To investigate Hypothesis 1:

The students decided to do their investigation at six sites along the river. They identified three sites (1,2, and 3) upstream of the industrial area and three sites (4, 5 and 6) along the industrial area.

(i) Suggest on reason why the students chose sites upstream of the industrial area and sites along the industrial area.

This part question was a bit challenging in that most responses lack the aspect of comparability.

Expected responses:

- For comparison
- For reliability to the study
- For data comparison between sites upstream and those along the industrial area.

(ii) State three possible dangers the students may face when conducting their investigation along the river.

This part question was more accessible to candidates across most centres on those that chose this question. Those that failed to score were those that were repeating either similar or related responses, or vague responses such as disease yet waterborne diseases was more appropriate.

Expected responses:

- Rivers may harbour dangerous animals/snakes/crocodiles
- They may get infections through waterborne diseases e.g. bilharzia, cholera, dysentery.
- There may be sharp slippery rock on the river bed and banks
- High water volumes/ fast water currents/ deep water may cause them to drown.

(c) Table 2 shows the parameters of the water that tested by the students.

The results of the students' average measurements, temperature, oxygen levels, pH and chlorine levels at each site are shown in Table 3.

The students plotted their results on Fig.13, 14, and Fig.15

Plot the average temperature value of the water at site 6 on Fig.13

One of the most accessible part questions, the plotting was well done by most candidates a few that failed to score incorrectly plotted and or incorrectly joined the plotted point to the ones already plotted points.

- (d) To investigate litter the students completed an environmental quality sheet Fig.16**
Write a conclusion to Hypothesis 1: *The industrial site has an impact on the quality of the water in the local river.* Use evidence from Table,3, Fig,13, 14, 15, and 16(Insert) to support your decision.

Compared with previous years, candidate performance on this part question showed a decline. While most candidates were able to take an appropriate stand, many failed to support their conclusions with relevant evidence. Few candidates selected and used data from the water-quality parameters to demonstrate the impact of the industrial area. Weaker responses relied on general statements rather than comparing measured data from upstream sites with those along the industrial area.

Expected responses:

- Hypothesis is true/correct
- Temperatures on sites (1,2,3) are lower (av.19-20°C) than sites (4,5,6) (av. 20°C - 26.5°C)
- pH values on sites (1,2,3) are neutral 6.8,7,7.2 yet on sites (4,5,6) are acidic 6.2 and alkaline 8.3 and 8.4
- chlorine levels are increasing from site 1 to 6, site1, 0.1 mg/l site 4, 0.3mg/l and site 6, 0.8mg/l
- Environmental quality total scores for litter at sites 1,2,3 total is lower at 4 whilst at sites 4,5,6 total score is higher at 14.

NB: When picking evidence from the different sources it should demonstrate change over the sites along the local river. All parameters must be supported by data in figures with units showing a trend/pattern of change.

- (e) Suggest two limitations to this investigation.**

One of the least accessible part questions in this question. Many candidates showed limited understanding of the concept of *limitations*. Instead of identifying weaknesses or constraints of the investigation, a significant number described *improvements* or ways the investigation could be made more reliable.

While such suggestions are relevant to evaluation, they do not address the specific demand of the question and therefore did not gain credit. Candidates are reminded that limitations refer to problems or weaknesses in the investigation as it was carried out (for example, small sample size or restricted time), not how it could be improved. Careful attention to command words is essential.

Expected responses:

- Use of one data collection method
- Attributing student/ human error/ subjectivity in data collection
- Investigation conducted only once.
- Fewer sites selected.

- (f) **To investigate Hypothesis 2: *The industrial site has more negative than positive impacts on the people.* They randomly interviewed 20 people found at the industrial area, asking them to rate the impact by ticking on an environmental quality survey sheet.**

(i) Define random sampling.

It was quite a challenging part question to define. Those who failed to score use random sampling to define the form of sampling. Some indicated that sampling involved the entire population.

Expected response:

Type of sampling in which the researcher selects a subset of participants from a population without any criteria, order or pattern/ selection by chance.

(ii) State two advantages of random sampling.

It was a fairly well-done question, with most candidates giving meaningful responses as opposed to one-word answers.

Expected responses:

- Easy / simple to conduct
- Faster/ time saving/ quicker to conduct
- Eliminates biasness/ free from bias
- Provides a representative sample
- Everyone has a chance of being selected.
-

- (g) **The students calculated the average score for each impact from the 20 people interviewed. These are shown in Table 4.**

Most candidates failed to score on this part question, particularly because they could have entered raw data yet they had to get total impacts first then convert for each into percentages.

Expected response:

Plot the total scores for the positive and negative impacts.

Positive impacts: $12/34 \times 100 = 35\%$

Negative impacts: $22/34 \times 100 = 65\%$

Correct shading for Positive impacts on the block bar graph

- (h) **Write a conclusion to Hypothesis 2: *The industrial site has more negative impacts than positive impacts on the people.* Use evidence from Fig.17 (Insert), Fig. 18 and Table 4 to support your answer.**

Again, in drawing a conclusion to the investigation most centres could only manage to take a stand, they failed to convincingly give supporting data from the sources referred to in this part question, and thus it was poorly done.

Expected responses:

- Hypothesis is correct/ true
- Fig.16 the total environmental quality score is low at 4 for positive impacts yet it is high at 13 for negative impacts.
- Table 4 total average for positive impacts is low at 11/12 but much higher for negative impacts at 22.
- In Fig 17, the percentage for positive impacts is (33/35%) while that of negative impacts is (65/67%).
-

- (i) **Suggest three ways by which this investigation can be improved by the students.**

Again, with most centres there is an indication that generic improvements can be developed for any form of investigation which fails to score in most cases.

Expected responses:

- Increase the sample size/ interview more people
- Substitute the EQS with a questionnaire.
- Investigate another industrial area with a similar setting ie a river passing along.
- Use of secondary data from Town Council/ Municipality or the Eswatini Environmental Authority/ relevant ministry

Question 6

This question, being the most unpopular of the two in this section, was chosen by very few candidates who performed below average.

Students at a local school in Eswatini were studying the impact of large-scale commercial sugarcane farming on the people living in the area.

They agreed on two hypotheses:

Hypothesis 1: *The commercial farming of sugar cane has brought more benefits than problems to the local people.*

Hypothesis 2: The number of shops and services has increased in the local town

- (a) To investigate Hypothesis 1: *The commercial farming of sugar cane has brought more benefits than problems to the local people*, the students used a questionnaire Fig.18 (Insert). They agreed on a sample size of 100 homesteads which they visited.

(i) Suggest two ways to improve this questionnaire.

A majority amongst those who attempted this question gave general features of a questionnaire and as such it was poorly done.

Expected responses:

- Improve the introduction/ be politer/ include greetings
- Expand on purpose of the study
- Include group name
- Include space for date/ time
- Make a provision for research area.

**(ii) The students decided to use stratified sampling in their choice of homesteads
State two advantages of using this method.**

This part question was poorly attempted by a majority of candidates who more often confused stratified with random and systematic sampling. More common answers were: it is cheap, saves time and it's easy to conduct.

Expected responses:

- It allows meaningful comparison between subgroupings
- Reduces human bias/ removes or eliminates human bias
- Can be used alongside other sampling techniques.
- All classes of the population can be studied within a sample
- It is more representative of the population being studied.

- (b) The answers to question 2: "What benefits have been brought by sugar cane farming to the area?" and Question 3: "What problems have been brought by sugar cane farming in the area?" are shown in Table 5 and Table 6 respectively.

(i) The students plotted the information from Table 5 on Fig.19. Use the results in Table 6 to complete Fig. 20.

This question was fairly well done by candidates by plotting and shading correctly following the given shade pattern. Some gave a different shade bigger bar width incorrectly placed.

Expected response:

Correct bar width of three mini squares, correct height of 40, bold solid shading

(ii) Write a conclusion to Hypothesis 1: *The commercial farming of sugar cane has brought more benefits than problems to the local people.* Support your conclusion with evidence from Table 5, Table 6, Fig. 19 and Fig.20.

While many candidates correctly identified the hypothesis as true, they often failed to support their conclusion with relevant evidence or data. As a result, responses lacked justification, which limited the level of credit awarded. Some candidates lifted evidence directly without reflecting on a comparison of more benefits than problems to local people.

Expected response:

- Hypothesis is correct/true
- Sugar cane farming has brought more benefits than problems/ benefits 6 types while problems are 5 types.
- There are more responses on benefits than problems
- All benefits total a higher percentage (50-80% than problems (30-45%)
- Average percentage for benefits is higher 70.6% while average percentage for problems is low at 38.4%
- The height of bars is taller in Fig.19 showing more benefits yet shorter in Fig. 20 showing fewer negative impacts.

(iii) Give three negative impacts of commercial farming on the environment besides pollution.

This part question was fairly well done by most candidates as most were able to score at maximum.

Expected responses:

- Deforestation/extinction of both plant and animal species/ trees are cut down/ loss of vegetation
- Loss of soil fertility /salinisation
- Soil compaction/ erosion/ land degradation
- Eutrophication/ loss of biodiversity
- Climate change / increased greenhouse gases/ global warming
- Disruption of food chains
- Disruption of the water cycle/ water supply / depletion of water
- Loss of habitat.

(c) One of the problems brought by sugar cane farming was the loss of land for subsistence farming. The students decided to do a land use survey to find out how land use has changed in the area from 2010 to 2020.

They used maps from the government survey department. Produced both in 2010 and 2020.

(i) State on advantage and one disadvantage of using the map.

A fairly well done part question most candidates would score on the advantage and lose a mark on the disadvantage.

Expected response:

Advantages:

- Can be used for comparison purpose
- It saves time / readily available.

Disadvantages:

- Information may be biased
- Information may be irrelevant
- Information may be outdated/ old/ limited/ details omitted.

(ii) Table 7 shows the results of the students' investigation. Use the results in table 7 to plot the percentage (%) change for banana in Fig.12.

A challenging part question to plot it was fairly well done by some candidates, since the 29 was just above division 28 but below 30. Some candidates would leave bars without shading or plot on the negative side which failed to score.

Expected response:

Correct plotting of height 29, within the bolded bars of width 5 on the positive side.

- (d)** To investigate **Hypothesis 2:** *The number of shops and services has increased in the local town*, the students carried out a field work to find out and map the number of shops and services in the town in 2020. They compared the data they collected to data from the 2010 map. Fig 23 (Insert) shows the maps.

(i) The students decided to classify the shops and services according to high and low order. What are high order goods.

A majority of candidates failed to score in this part question. Most expressions in their definition was vague some gave responses such as high quality, demand or those with a large sphere of influence.

Expected responses:

- Goods that are bought rarely
- Infrequently bought
- Goods that are expensive / pricey when buying

The students used the map of the town in 2010 to complete Table 8.

(ii) Use the information in Fig. 22 to complete Table

It was a fairly well done part question particularly by those that carefully used the map to complete Table 9. However, some failed to score due to incorrectly counting the number of goods and services.

Expected responses:

High order

MTN services2

Hardware store.....4

Super market.....4

Low order

Restaurant /Bar.....5

(iii) Use the results in Table.9 to complete the pie graph, Fig 23 for the total number of high and low order goods, for the year 2020.

This question was well done only by those candidates who got (d)(ii) correctly, those that missed it failed to score.

In table 9 the total for high order is 24 and the total for low order is 29,

$$\begin{aligned}\text{High order} &= 24/53 \times 360^{\circ} \\ &= 163^{\circ}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Low order} &= 29/53 \times 360^{\circ} \\ &= 197^{\circ}\end{aligned}$$

Candidates were expected to plot this on Fig. 23

Expected response:

Correct plotting on Fig. 23 with both sectors in their proportion with the correct key.

(e) Write a conclusion to Hypothesis 2: The number of shops and services have increased in the local town. Use evidence from Table 8, Table 9, Fig.22 and Fig. 23 to support your answer.

Although many candidates correctly stated that the hypothesis was true, they often failed to support their conclusion with relevant evidence or data. This limited the quality of their responses, indicating limited application of evidence-based reasoning, as conclusions must be justified using appropriate data evidence extracted and interpreted from the various sources cited in the question.

Expected response:

- Hypothesis is correct / true
- The number of shops and services in 2020 is higher / more at 53 yet in 2010 it was less at 25
- The number of higher order goods and services in 2010 was less/ low at 10 while in 2020 it was higher/ more at 24
- The number of low order goods and services in 2010 was less at 15 yet the number of low order goods and services in 2020 was higher at 29

(f) Suggest two ways by which this investigation can be improved to make the results more reliable.

Many students did not suggest realistic or relevant improvements to the investigation of the local town. As a result, there was limited consideration of how data collection methods could be improved to make results more reliable.

Expected response:

- Carry out the study in another town
- Consider other shops and services
- Refer to other sources of secondary data from the local town board

Concluding Message

To succeed in Paper 2, candidates must demonstrate accurate interpretation, clear analysis and disciplined examination technique. Centres are encouraged to strengthen skills-based teaching, particularly in map reading, graph interpretation, data handling and photographic analysis, to improve candidate performance in future examinations.

There was a general improvement in following the rubric, although some centres still had candidates who did not follow the instructions, particularly in Section C. Centres are reminded that candidates should answer either Question 5 or Question 6, not both. Evidence shows that attempting both questions within the given time reduces performance in Section C and often affects the overall paper. Higher-ability candidates performed well on the more demanding questions that required explanation and judgement, especially those involving hypothesis testing. In Section C, Question 5 was more accessible than Question 6, although both questions were attempted reasonably well. Candidates should be encouraged to write more concisely and to think carefully before responding.

Question 5(e) and Question 6(f) required candidates to identify specific limitations of the investigations and to suggest appropriate improvements to enhance the reliability of the results. These questions continue to present difficulties for many candidates, despite being frequently assessed. Centres are therefore encouraged to provide regular practice in responding to this type of question. In addition, centres should avoid teaching generic limitations or improvements that could apply to any fieldwork investigation, as such responses tend to be vague and rarely gain credit. Candidates are expected to relate limitations and improvements directly to the investigation described.

